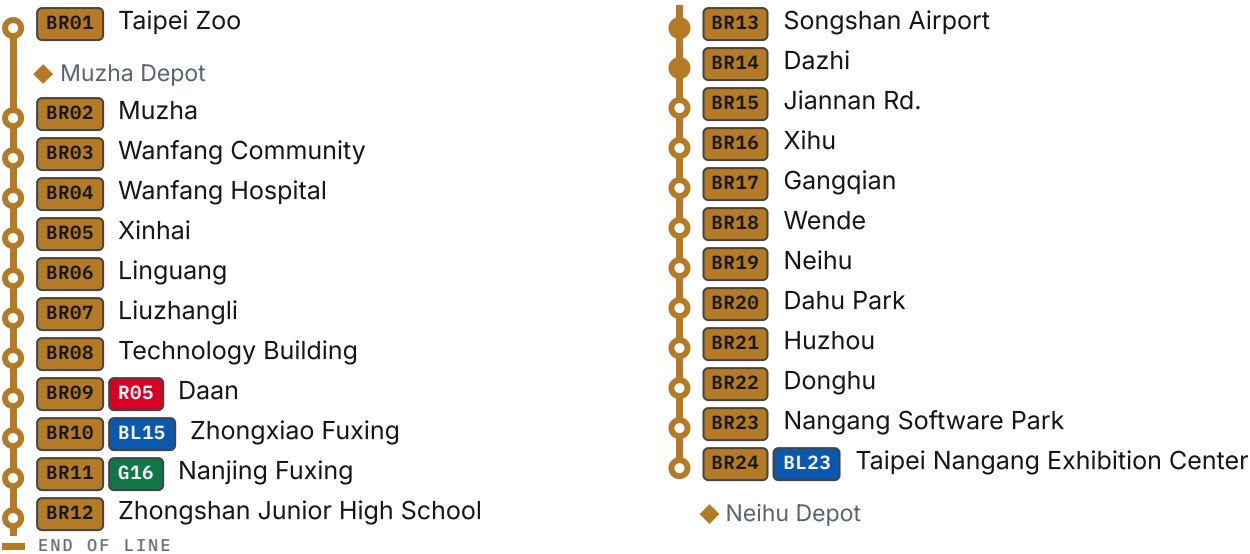


Wenhu Line

Taipei's driverless brown line — no cab, a front window you can stand at, and a rubber-tyred guideway that climbs hills the rest of the network cannot.

THE LINE



ELEVATED

BR WENHU LINE 文湖線			
LINE CODE BR	OPERATOR Taipei Rapid Transit Corporation	TERMINI BR01 — BR24	STATIONS 24 ^[2]
ELEVATED 22 ^[2]	UNDERGROUND BR13, BR14 ^[4]	OPENED 28 March 1996 ^[2]	LAST EXTENSION 4 July 2009 ^[2]
END TO END 45 min ^[3]	GUIDEWAY Rubber-tyred, side-guided ^[10]	ELECTRIFICATION 750 V DC third rail ^[4]	SIGNALLING CITYFLO 650, Bombardier (now Alstom) ^[4]
AUTOMATION GoA4, driverless ^[4]	DEPOTS Muzha, Neihu		

PHOTOGRAPH WANTED

A train on the elevated guideway, shot from street level — the line is fully elevated here, so the structure and a passing train are both reachable without a permit.

The Wenhua Line guideway.

There is no cab. Stand at the front of the leading car and the guideway comes straight at you — through the hills above Muzha [\[/rail/stations/br02/\]](/rail/stations/br02/), across the rooftops of eastern Taipei, over the Keelung River into Neihu [\[/rail/stations/br19/\]](/rail/stations/br19/). It is the best free view in the city, and it exists because nobody needs to sit where you are standing.

The Wenhua Line was **Taiwan's first metro line** ^[11], and it remains the only line in the Taipei network running on rubber tyres rather than steel wheels. That choice is what lets it climb through Wenshan's hills; the precise gradients it clears are a figure this site has not yet sourced, and the design criteria that would settle them are still to be found.

History

The name is a contraction: **Wenshan** and **Neihu**, the districts at either end. The two halves opened thirteen years apart, and they are the two halves of one of the strangest procurement stories in modern transit.

STAGE	SECTION	LENGTH	OPENED
Muzha Line	BR01 — BR12	10.9 km ^[2]	28 March 1996 ^[2]
Neihu extension	BR13 — BR24	14.8 km ^[2]	4 July 2009 ^[2]

The original section was bought in 1988 as a turnkey system from France's Matra ^[5]. What followed — two test-track fires in 1993, an opening four and a quarter years late, the builder's withdrawal from maintaining its own system, and a lawsuit that ran until the Supreme Court ordered the city to pay roughly NT\$1.64 billion in 2005 ^[5] ^[6] — is told in full on its own page: **The Matra dispute** [\[/rail/history/matra-dispute/\]](/rail/history/matra-dispute/). The short version is that Taipei learned, expensively, how not to buy a railway, and bought the second half differently.

When the Neihu extension opened on 4 July 2009, the two sections began running as one through line under the extension's new CITYFLO 650 signalling ^[2] ^[4]. The original VAL256 fleet was withdrawn that same day for conversion to the new system and did not carry passengers again until 26 December 2010 ^[7] — eighteen months in which the 1996 railway ran entirely on the 2009 trains. See VAL256 [\[/rail/rolling-stock/val256/\]](/rail/rolling-stock/val256/).

Route

Elevated for almost its entire length. From **BR01** the line climbs north through Wenshan District, crosses central Taipei on an east–west alignment, then turns north-east across the Keelung River into Neihu.

Two of the twenty-four stations are underground: **BR13 Songshan Airport** [/rail/stations/br13/] and **BR14 Dazhi** [/rail/stations/br14/] [4]. Both are on the Neihu section, which DORTS records as carrying 3.9 km of underground running and two underground stations [2] — so the primary record and the encyclopedia agree, from different directions. The platform depths are still not established here and are not asserted.

Every platform on the line has full-height platform screen doors: Faiveley equipment from **BR01** to **BR12**, ST Electronics from **BR13** to **BR24** [9].

Operations

Trains run without on-board drivers under automatic train control, at GoA4 — unattended train operation, the highest grade [4].

Weekday headways are about 2–4 minutes at peak, 4–10 off-peak, and about 12 minutes after 23:00; weekends and holidays run the off-peak pattern all day [3]. **End to end takes about 45 minutes**, **BR01** to **BR24** or the reverse [3]. zh.wikipedia adds that the headway can be compressed to 80 seconds [4]; that is a signalling capability rather than a timetable, and no primary source for it was found.

How long the line is

Three figures circulate, and they are not in conflict — they measure three different things.

FIGURE	WHAT IT MEASURES	SOURCE
25.17 km	Revenue length, BR01 to BR24	TDX <code>CumulativeDistance</code> against the last station of route BR-1 [1]
25.7 km	The two construction projects added together	10.9 km + 14.8 km, both DORTS's own figures [2]
25.04 km	This site's own measurement along MOTC's surveyed geometry	the map below

The 25.7 km that appears as 路線長度 on zh.wikipedia [4] is the **sum of the two published section lengths**: DORTS records 木柵線 約10.9公里 and 內湖線 約14.8公里, and $10.9 + 14.8 = 25.7$ exactly [2]. Those are project lengths — the extent of what was built, including non-revenue track at each end — which is why the total exceeds the 25.17 km of railway that carries passengers [1].

Rolling stock

Two fleets share the line, both four-car formations built as permanently coupled pairs:

- VAL256 `[/rail/rolling-stock/val256/]` — 51 pairs, the original Muzha Line fleet^[7]
- Innovia APM 256 (C370) `[/rail/rolling-stock/innovia-apm-256-c370/]` — 101 pairs, delivered for the Neihu extension^[8]

They are not the same vehicle and not the same design lineage — the second was built by a competitor to fit the first's guideway, which is the Matra story's last chapter — but the interface they share is exact: the same running-surface spacing, the same side guide bars, the same 750 V taken off them^[8] ^[10]. TRTC `[/rail/operators/trtc/]` has announced a programme to replace all 76 trains by 2041 — see the research notes, and treat the figures as provisional.

Depots

Muzha Depot `[/rail/depots/muzha-depot/]` sits at the southern end beside `BR01` and opened with the line in 1996^[2]. Neihu Depot `[/rail/depots/neihu-depot/]` was built for the extension and came into use in 2009^[2]. Despite its name it is in Nangang District, and it joins the running line at `BR24`, at the far end of the line^[2].

Sources

Station names, codes, running order, coordinates and the end-to-end journey time come from **Taiwan MOTC's TDX platform**, operator TRTC — government open data, retrieved 5 August 2026. The strip map is generated from it directly. Everything else is cited inline and listed below.

TDX does not publish station structure, headways, or anything about rolling stock and depots; those come from TRTC's and DORTS's own publications where they exist, and are marked secondary where they do not.

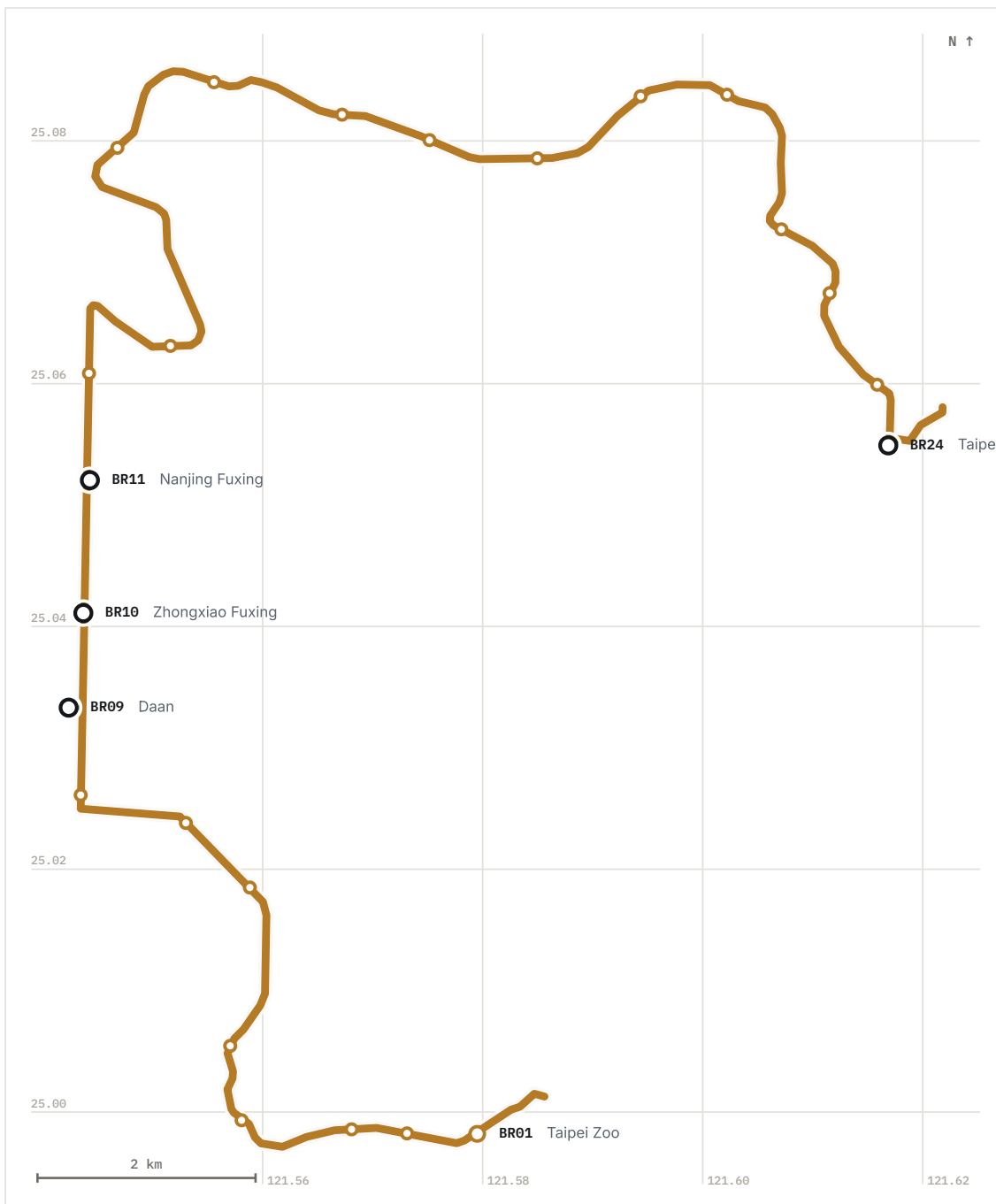
Corrections

This page's errors are corrected in place and recorded here, most recent first.

- **The strip map drew Neihu Depot at the wrong end of the line for four builds.** This page previously said the depot joined the running line near `BR19` Neihu — an unsourced inference from the shared name. It actually connects at `BR24`, in Nangang District^[2], and the map marker moved with the fact. `npm run facts` now cross-checks the marker against the depot page's own stated junction.
- **Two engineering superlatives were removed rather than corrected.** This page used to say the gradients through Wenshan were steeper than conventional heavy metro could manage, and that the elevated curves would be *impossible* on a steel-wheel alignment. Both are

probably true and neither was sourced, and "impossible" was doing a great deal of unattributed work. They can return when DORTS's design criteria are found.

- **The 25.7 km figure was described as unaccounted for.** An earlier version of this page could not say where the widely-circulated 25.7 km came from. It is simply the sum of DORTS's two project lengths, as the length section above now shows.



The line as surveyed, from MOTC route geometry — 25.0 km measured along the alignment from the first station to the last. Termini and interchanges are labelled; every station has a name on hover.

Specifications

Route length, revenue	25.17 km ^[1]
Route length, published	25.7 km ^[2]
Stations	24 ^[2]
Elevated stations	22 ^[2]
Underground stations	2 ^[2]
Underground running	3.9 km ^[2]
Guideway spacing	1880 mm ^[4]
Electrification	750 V DC ^[4]
Automation grade	GoA4 ^[4]
Peak headway	2–4 min ^[3]
Off-peak headway	4–10 min ^[3]
Late-evening headway	12 min ^[3]
Design minimum headway	80 s ^[4]
Maximum operating speed	70 km/h ^[4]
Design speed	80 km/h ^[4]
End-to-end journey	45 min ^[3]

References

4 of 11 sources on this page are primary — published by the operator, the builder or government.

1

Taiwan MOTC TDX — StationOfRoute, operator TRTC

PRIMARY

Ministry of Transportation and Communications, Taiwan

accessed 2026-08-05

archived

Government open data, committed to this repository at data/tdx/. The route's revenue length is the CumulativeDistance against the last station of route BR-1; the RouteLength field is zero for every metro route, which is what once led this page to say the figure was not published.

2

Wenshan—Neihu Line

PRIMARY

Taipei City Government, Department of Rapid Transit Systems (DORTS)

accessed 2026-08-06

archived

The builder's own project record for both halves: 木柵線 約10.9公里，設12座車站 and 內湖線 約14.8公里，設12座車站（地下段3.9公里，2座地下站）. Those two lengths are what add to the 25.7 km that circulates as this line's route length.

3 Routes and headways [<https://www.metro.taipei/cp.aspx?n=EAD981369A065968>]

路線及班距

PRIMARY Taipei Rapid Transit Corporation accessed 2026-08-06

archived [<https://web.archive.org/web/20260803093910/https://www.metro.taipei/cp.aspx?n=EAD981369A065968>]

The operator's own published service pattern. Weekday peak about 2–4 min, off-peak about 4–10 min, about 12 min after 23:00, and one-way running time about 45 minutes.

4 Wenhua line [<https://zh.wikipedia.org/zh-tw/文湖線>]

文湖線

SECONDARY 維基百科 (Chinese Wikipedia) accessed 2026-08-06

Carries both length figures in one infobox — 路線長度 25.7公里 against 營運長度 25.18公里 — which is what showed the two were never in conflict. Also the source for the 1,880 mm sleeper-centre spacing, the electrification, the speeds, and the identification of **BR13** and **BR14**.

5 Muzha Line [<https://zh.wikipedia.org/zh-tw/木柵線>]

木柵線

SECONDARY 維基百科 (Chinese Wikipedia) accessed 2026-08-06

The fullest chronology of the original section's construction years — the 1988 Matra contract, the 1993 test fires, the 1996 opening.

6 Muzha metro line: Matra wins, Taipei to pay NT\$1.64 billion [<https://www.epochtimes.com/b5/5/7/23/n995027.htm>]

木柵捷運線 馬特拉勝訴 北市要賠16.4億

SECONDARY 孫友廉，陳曉宜，鄭學庸，自由時報，23 July 2005 (via 大紀元 reprint)

accessed 2026-08-06

The report of the judgment that ended the Matra litigation, cited here for the headline figures; the full account is on the Matra dispute page.

7 Taipei Metro VAL256 electric multiple unit [<https://zh.wikipedia.org/zh-tw/台北捷運VAL256型電聯車>]

台北捷運VAL256型電聯車

SECONDARY 維基百科 (Chinese Wikipedia) accessed 2026-08-06

8 Bombardier INNOVIA APM 256 electric multiple unit [https://zh.wikipedia.org/zh-tw/龐巴迪INNOVIA_APM_256型電聯車]

龐巴迪INNOVIA APM 256型電聯車

SECONDARY 維基百科 (Chinese Wikipedia) accessed 2026-08-06

9 Safety equipment [<https://www.metro.taipei/cp.aspx?n=c4b618682db27979&s=288E97B4A5E9A725>]

安全設備

PRIMARY Taipei Rapid Transit Corporation accessed 2026-08-06

archived [https://web.archive.org/web/20250616230758/https://www.metro.taipei/cp.aspx?n=C4B618682DB27979&s=288E97B4A5E9A725]

- 10** Lille VAL — project profile [https://www.railway-technology.com/projects/lille_val/] SECONDARY Railway Technology accessed 2026-08-06

Describes the VAL guideway — running surfaces with lateral H-section guide bars that also carry the 750 V supply. Side guidance, not a central rail.

- 11** That day, that year: 28 March 1996, Taiwan's first metro line, the Muzha Line, opens [https://www.peoplenews.tw/news/19facc82-2320-47f3-8e14-0f62366535f9]

【那一年的這一天】1996.3.28 台灣第一條捷運「木柵線」通車

SECONDARY 民報 Taiwan People News accessed 2026-08-06

archived [https://web.archive.org/web/20191207073911/https://www.peoplenews.tw/news/19facc82-2320-47f3-8e14-0f62366535f9]

Cited for the "first in Taiwan" claim, which had been on this page as a bare superlative. The live URL rotted some time before 6 August 2026 — the citation survives only because the Internet Archive holds a 2019 capture, which is the archiving policy's whole argument made for it.

Last updated: 2026-08-06

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Station names, codes and sequence from TDX Transport Data eXchange, Ministry of Transportation and Communications, operator TRTC. Government open data. Retrieved 2026-08-05; source last updated 2020-01-31. Provenance.